

FOR CREATIVE STRATEGISTS

Struggling to close a client without a portfolio?

Most people are stuck in the same loop. Here is the way out.

THE LOOP

Cannot get clients without a portfolio. Cannot build a portfolio without clients.

So you stall. Days pile up. The laptop feels heavy. Your own content does not excite you the way it used to. The outreach doc stays open, untouched, for a week.



WHY THE LOOP FORMS

Most creative strategists treat a portfolio like the entry ticket.

Clients do not. What they want is evidence that you can think about their specific business.

WAY OUT 1. SPEC WORK

Pick three brands in your niche. Write the ad you wish they were running. Publish it with one line of thinking.

WAY OUT 2. PUBLIC TEARDOWNS

One teardown per week. What is working. What you would test. What the test would reveal.

WAY OUT 3. A STRATEGY PAGE

A one-page piece of thinking about five prospects. Sent unsolicited. No rate. No call ask.

PICK THE ONE THAT FITS

**If public accountability keeps you moving,
teardowns.**

If you prefer direct outreach, the strategy page.

If you need to see polish first, spec work.

**Want the prompt that walks you
through picking one?**

Full quiz at creativestrategyos.com/quiz.